

Yifan ZHANG

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Current Position

Postdoctoral Fellow, Kellogg School of Management, Northwestern University, 2025 - present
Supervisor: Nancy Qian

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, Toulouse School of Economics, 2025
Thesis: Essays on Economic History and Political Economy
Advisors: Victor Gay, Paul Seabright, Mohamed Saleh (first two years)

Visiting student, Department of Economics, Northwestern University, April-July 2024
Host: Joel Mokyr

M.A. in Economic Theory and Econometrics, Toulouse School of Economics, 2020

B.B.A. in Economics, The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen, 2018

Research Fields

Primary: Development Economics, Political Economy, Economic History
Secondary: Culture and Institutions, Gender Economics, Media Economics

References

Nancy Qian

James J. O'Connor Professor
Northwestern University
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Victor Gay

Professor of Economics
Toulouse School of Economics
victor.gay@tse-fr.eu

Paul Seabright

Professor of Economics
Toulouse School of Economics
paul.seabright@tse-fr.eu

Marco E. Tabellini

Assistant Professor of Business Administration
Harvard University
mtabellini@hbs.edu

Working Papers

The Transmission of Son Preference

Job Market Paper

Radio Propaganda and Job Choice with Mingduo Zhao (University of British Columbia)

The Economic Determinants of Taiwanese Sentiments towards Reunification with Mainland China
with Yu-Chi Hsieh (Northwestern), Nancy Qian (Northwestern), and Marco Tabellini (Harvard)

Selected Work in Progress

Historical Narratives and National Identities

Seminars & Conferences

2027 ASSA (Washington DC, scheduled)

2026 National Taiwan University (x2), Economic History Association Meeting (St. Louis), Asia Meeting of the Econometric Society-China (Hong Kong),

2025 Institutional and Organizational Economics Academy (Corsica), Northwestern University (x2), Toulouse School of Economics

2024 ASREC Annual Conference (Chapman University), Annual Symposium on Quantitative History (Shanghai), Cliometric Annual Conference (Washington DC), Econometric Society European Meeting (Rotterdam), Economic History Society Annual Conference (Newcastle), Stockholm School of Economics, London School of Economics, Northwestern University, Toulouse School of Economics

2021-2023 Quantitative History Workshop (Shanghai), ENTER Jamboree (Manheim), Toulouse School of Economics (x5), ENTER Jamboree webinar (virtual discussant)

Grants & Awards

Postdoc Conference Travel Grant, Northwestern University	2026
Final Year Fellowship, Toulouse School of Economics	2024-2025
Conference Bursary, Economic History Society	2024
Mobility Grant (7,180 EUR), Toulouse School of Economics	2024
Doctoral Fellowship, French Ministry of Education	2021-2024
First-year Ph.D. Student Fellowship, Toulouse School of Economics	2020
The Galaxy World Student Entrepreneur Fund (80,000 CNY)	2015
Half Tuition Scholarship (190,000 CNY), The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen	2014-2018

Referee Service

Economics of Transition and Institutional Change

Research Experience

Research assistant to Victor Gay (Toulouse School of Economics)	2024-2025
Research assistant to Zhuang (John) Liu (The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen)	2016-2018

Teaching Experience

Teaching assistant for Microeconomics (Undergraduate), TSE. Instructor: Lucie Bottega, spring 2024

Teaching assistant for Macroeconomics (Undergraduate), TSE. Instructor: Patrick Fève, fall 2023

Teaching assistant for Program Evaluation (Graduate), TSE. Instructor: Thierry Magnac, spring 2023

Teaching assistant for Industrial Organization (Undergraduate), TSE. Instructor: Isabelle Dubec, spring 2022

Professional Service

Economic History Society, *Student Ambassador* 2022-2025

The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen, *Alumni Advisor* 2022-2023

Others

Languages: Mandarin Chinese (native), Cantonese (fluent), English (fluent), French (basic)

IT skills: ArcGIS, Matlab, Python, R, Stata

Last updated: September 22, 2026